



STAT ATTACK
It's all in the numbers

Apache is the **most used** web server at **48.4%** of all Web servers.

In 2007, the **speed** of Cable Broadband increased by **27%**

50% of all mobile phones **stolen** are made by **Nokia**

30% of Internet users in Finland used the **Net** for formal education

In 2007, Korea had the **highest share (94%)** of households with access to the Net

62% of UK citizens have access to **digital television**

exclusive movie channels each, Big TV has a whopping 32 exclusive movie channels, but this feature will not be as big an incentive as it appears, because the users have to pay for everything that they watch. The picture-in-picture view (PiP) or multichannel views in Big TV is 12, whereas in the other two, there's an upper limit at 8. The audio broadcasted across all Big TV channels is CD quality. Unlike Dish TV and Tata Sky, Big TV will be broadcasting all the sports channels available in the subcontinent. Moreover, the DTH service will have the backing of Adlabs.

Big TV matches or better the competition in other small features as well. There are over 200 channels available with the subscription, 120 movies, and a promise of a new movies every fifteen days.

The best offer in terms of pleasing the customers is that any one of the available regional sections are completely free.

The launch offer for the service is Rs 1,490, which includes 10 audio channels, 20 movie channels free for 3 months, and one regional pack.

There are various subscription schemes ranging from Rs 100 to Rs 475.

The biggest advantage is of course the DVD quality images being broadcast. If everything goes well, Reliance plans to put up eight to ten HDTV (High Definition Television) channels by the end of the year.

BIG BLUE BUMPS FLASH MEMORY

IBM Tests 4 Terabyte Solid State Array

IBM tested an array of 120 Fusion-IO supplied SSD (Steady State Disks) with a total capacity of 4.1 terabytes. IBM is preparing these arrays for use in industrial computation, which will tentatively be ready in a year's time. The system has achieved a high data read/write rate with a response time of less than 1 millisecond. IBM has achieved a data transfer rate of over 1 million IOPS (Input/Output per second). Intel retails its X25E 3.8 TB SSD array which achieves a data transfer rate of 4.2 million IOPS.

Solid State drives have been around for some time now in hand-held devices like MP3 players and PDAs, but their application for industrial or personal computing purposes have been limited.

This is mostly because the traditional hard drives used to cost about one

fourth of the steady state drives per unit of memory.

There are however many advantages of the steady state drives, which have no moving parts like a read/write head or a platter.

This means steady state drives can start up much faster than traditional hard drives, with no RAM or flash requirements and faster access to the data.

There are a lot of limitations of a SSD drive though, apart from the cost. SSDs are highly susceptible to data loss, which can be caused by power failure, magnetic fields or stray electrostatic charges, all of which are common occurrences wherever SSDs are likely to be used.

IBM is working on these aspects of solid state storage, and are increasing the performances to make the solid state storage solutions reliable over long periods of time.

As the higher IOPS speeds are likely to be used in places that have to access large databases, the reliability of the SSDs is critical. IBM is testing the feasibility of such operations.

UNIQUE WEDLOCKS

Matrimonial Sites Go Niche

For a long time, Bharatmatrimony.com and Shaadi.com were the leading matrimo-

Buzzword of the MONTH

Shiretoko

The Shiretoko is an early alpha version of the next Mozilla Firefox release. It is also known as the Gecko 1.9.1 Alpha, because it is based on Mozilla's Gecko layout engine. This version is available for Linux, Mac and Windows systems for testing purposes only, and everyone who uses it is expected to run into bugs and report it to bugzilla. Once installed, Shiretoko looks exactly like

the Firefox browser, only there is a blue world icon without a fox flying around it. There are some improvements in the interface, and more control over themes and plugins, but no drastic and apparent advancement. Although shiretoko automatically installs all the firefox add-ons, some don't install at all, run sluggishly or crash the browser outright which seems to be the only major problem with Shiretoko.